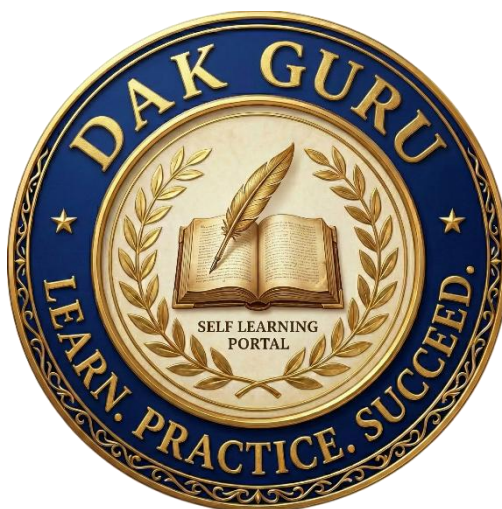


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PRESERVATION PERIOD OF RECORDS

Retention & Disposal Schedule

Study Material for LDCE — Inspector Posts (IP) & PS Group 'B' Examinations

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DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly for examination and study purposes. Although the retention periods have been compiled and cross-checked against the Department of Posts 'Compendium on Preservation and Disposal of Records', Rule 25 of Postal Manual Volume VI (Part I) and Appendix 5 of the P&T Financial Hand Book Volume I, it is a study aid only and does not constitute an official order. Rules are amended from time to time; where a later order modifies any provision, the latest order in force will prevail. Readers and departmental users must verify the current position from official government circulars, gazette notifications and departmental manuals before relying on any figure for operational or audit use.

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Contents

A guided map to this booklet

This booklet is organised in three parts. Part A explains the *framework and general rules* governing the preservation and destruction of postal records — the ‘why’ and ‘how’. **Part B** reorganises every record *by its retention period* (Immediate → Permanent) for fast memorisation and revision. **Part C** gives quick-reference schedules for the SB Control Organisation and Foreign Post.

Part A — Foundations: Records, Recording & Disposal

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SBCO / Pairing records · Internal Check Organisation (SB) · Foreign Post general rule.

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Part A — Foundations: Records, Recording & Disposal

Why records are kept, and the rules for keeping and destroying them

Every Post Office generates a large volume of registers, vouchers, journals and correspondence. Keeping the right record for the right period — and safely destroying the rest — is essential for **audit compliance, quick retrieval and a clean, well-managed office**. The rules below apply uniformly across all sections and are among the most frequently tested topics in the IP and PS Group 'B' examinations.

A.1 What is a 'Record'?

Under the Right to Information Act, 2005, a **"record"** includes: (a) any document, manuscript and file; (b) any microfilm, microfiche and facsimile copy of a document; (c) any reproduction of image(s) embedded in such microfilm (whether enlarged or not); and (d) any other material produced by a computer or any other device.

Thus a record is not limited to paper — it includes data held in *electronic / soft-copy form*. This is why, in the CBS environment, 'long books', 'lists of transactions' and 'ledger details' held in soft copy are governed by the same retention periods as their physical counterparts.

A.2 Recording & the Record Room

"Recording" is the process of closing a file after action on all issues is complete (Chapter VII, Manual of Office Procedure). Key points:

- Every file to be recorded is stamped **"To be destroyed"** (with the year of destruction) or **"Permanent Record"**; an entry is made in the File Register under 'Date of Recording'.
- Purely ephemeral files are NOT recorded — they are destroyed as soon as they are one year old.
- Recording is done once every month by each section.
- On the fly-leaf of the Sectional Register of old files, an up-to-date extract of the preservation-period orders should be pasted.
- In the Record Room, files are arranged section-wise and chronologically; a Record Review Register (year-wise / section-wise, by year of destruction) is maintained, and a requisition-slip system controls movement of files.

A.3 The governing authorities

The retention periods are scattered across several departmental manuals and are consolidated in the DoP **Compendium on Preservation and Disposal of Records**

(Rafi Ahmed Kidwai National Postal Academy, Ghaziabad). The principal authorities are:

- **Rule 25, Postal Manual Volume VI (Part I)** — general framework, method of destruction and records needing special permission.
- **Appendix 5 (Annexure 'A', Parts I / II / III), P&T Financial Hand Book Volume I** — the detailed retention schedules; Rule 69 (ACG-91) and Rule 94 (audit objections).
- **POSB Manual Volumes I & II**, and the **Postal Manual of SB Control, Pairing & Internal Check Organisation** — Savings Bank, Certificate and SBCO records.
- **Book of Rules for Branch Offices** (Rule 21) and the **Foreign Post Manual** (Rule 11 / Rule 400) — BO and foreign-post records.
- **Master Circular No. 1 on AML/CFT** — issued vide SB Order 14/2012 and amended by SB Order 08/2013 — CBS-era record-keeping for SB / Certificates.

A.4 Records that shall NOT be destroyed on any account

Irrespective of any minimum period, these must be retained (Appendix 5, P&T FHB Vol. I):

- (a) Records connected with expenditure that is within the period of limitation fixed by law.
- (b) Records connected with expenditure on projects, schemes or works not completed — even beyond the period of limitation.
- (c) Records connected with claims to service and personal matters of persons in service.
- (d) Orders and sanctions of a permanent character, until revised.

A.5 Records NOT to be destroyed without the Head of Circle's permission

A classic examination list (Rule 25(3), PM Vol. VI Part I; Rule 17(2), PM Vol. VII):

- i. Post Office Order Book (except in Branch Offices).
- ii. Register of undeliverable passbooks in deposit in the Head Office.
- iii. Post Office certificate Ledger (used under the old procedure).
- iv. Correspondence and documents on which an enquiry is in progress, or connected with cases not fully decided / closed.
- v. Character sheets of officials in service and **those who have absconded**.
- vi. Order book of a record office.
- vii. Nominal roll of Token holders.
- viii. Works papers / correspondence / documents on which an enquiry is in progress or connected with undecided / unclosed cases.

A.6 How records are destroyed

- General rule: **old records are torn up and sold as waste paper** to contractors by calling tenders for fixed periods. If no buyer can be found, they are destroyed by fire.
- Destroyed by fire (must not be reusable): **(i) Confidential Records; (ii) Book of Postmarks.**
- In SBCO / Pairing / ICO: vouchers, spoilt and undeliverable passbooks, and unused cheque foils are destroyed by burning; other records are torn and handed to the Postmaster for sale as waste paper.

A.7 Register of destruction — Form ACG-91

Remember — ACG-91

A register of destruction of records in Form **ACG-91** must be maintained in *every* office and preserved **permanently**. Full particulars of all records destroyed are entered in it (Rule 69, P&T FHB Vol. I).

A.8 The audit-objection safeguard

Account records against which **audit objections are pending shall NOT be destroyed** until final settlement. Before ordering destruction, the office must ensure that no audit objection is pending for the period in question (Note below Rule 94, P&T FHB Vol. I).

A.9 Other overriding principles

- An article of foreign post under dispute, or any case under enquiry, is kept until the matter is settled — even if the prescribed period is exceeded.
- All records connected with complaints involving pecuniary claims must be preserved (Note below Rule 25(1)(b), PM Vol. VI Part I).
- Wherever a loss is likely or monetary responsibility may arise, records are preserved until responsibility is fixed.

A.10 High-yield periods worth memorising

Frequently-tested figures

GDS (Gramin Dak Sevak) acquittance rolls → **45 years** (for verification of service).

Unclaimed savings certificates in PAO custody → **30 years** from date of maturity.

Pay Bill Register / Book of Establishment / Letter of authority for payment → **35 years**.

Indemnity bonds for duplicate certificates → **6 years beyond maturity / extended maturity** (e.g. 5-year NSC → 23 years; 7-year NSC → 18 years from issue).

Register of destruction (ACG-91), Nominal Roll, Runner's appointment certificates, silent-account ledger folios, and the SBCO list of silent accounts → **Permanent**.

Part B — Preservation Periods at a Glance

Every record reorganised by its retention period, from Immediate to Permanent

The tables below cover the **Head / Sub Post Office and Branch Post Office** (the core examinable material). Each row shows the branch, the record, and the exact period — including any condition attached (“after the accounts are closed”, “after the next inspection”, etc.). For the SB Control Organisation and Foreign Post, see Part C.

Immediate / Variable (destroyed forthwith or on an event)

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Bank	SB Ledgers in the Head Office	Destroyed forthwith by the Postmaster after all accounts are closed / transferred / recopied and the Postal Accounts Office certifies that all discrepant ledger items are settled. Folios of silent accounts are extracted and kept separately in a special register.
Savings Bank	Sub Office SB Journals	Destroyed by the Sub Postmaster after SB ledgers are prepared for all accounts standing in the Sub Office.
Savings Bank	Specimen Signature Books – HO	Destroyed forthwith by the Postmaster after the application forms of all pending accounts have been prepared.
Savings Bank	Authority for operating a public account	Retained till closure of the account.
Savings Bank	Government Security Holder’s Rolls	Retained so long as the securities remain in custody.
Savings Certificates	Yearly list of unsold POSCs	After the PAO certifies settlement of all discrepant items for that year, or after 2 years, whichever is later.
Stock	Postal and other publications	After supply of new editions.
Stock	Invoices of publications & books of blank forms	After receipt of the first invoice for the year (destroyed by the Inspecting Officer during inspection).
Miscellaneous	Circulars of a permanent nature bearing the title “Standing Orders”	On specific instructions from the competent authority.

One (1) Year

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Mail & Sorting	All records of the Mail department except Mail Lists (and those provided elsewhere)	1 year
Registration & Parcel	All records of the Registration / Parcel department except Registered & Parcel lists (and those elsewhere)	1 year
Accounts	Monthly statements of fluctuating charges (Form A)	1 year
Accounts	Inspection reports from the Audit / Accounts Office	1 year after the next inspection, provided all items are settled
Accounts	Correspondence relating to fund deduction, etc.	1 year
Accounts	Gazetted Officer's Pay Slips	1 year
Accounts	Charge Reports (office copies)	1 year
Accounts	GPF – records relating to membership	1 year
Accounts	GPF – records relating to nomination	1 year (original / authenticated nomination to be placed in Vol. II of the Service Book / Personal File)
Accounts	GPF – records re financing of insurance policies from GPF	1 year (authenticated copy of the sanction to be placed on the personal file)
Accounts	GPF – records re adjustment of missing credits	1 year
Accounts	GPF – records re final withdrawal (house-building, higher / technical education of children, etc.)	1 year
Accounts	GPF annual statements	1 year
Accounts	Register of Sanctioned Establishment	At the end of 1 year after a new one is prepared
Telephones	Counterfoils of receipts in Form Eng-8	1 year
Savings Bank	List of withdrawals of ₹2,500 or more at BOs & single-handed SOs (with verification reports)	1 year
Savings Bank	Guard file – applications for conversion of CTD accounts	1 year
Savings Bank	Guard file – applications for grant of certificate of deposits in CTD accounts	1 year

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Staff	Service records of ED / GDS agents	1 year from date of termination of service
Miscellaneous	Inspection & verification reports by the executive	1 year after the next inspection, provided all items are settled
Miscellaneous	Correspondence re robberies, thefts, frauds, tampering with / loss of registered & parcel articles and prosecutions	1 year after the cases are closed
Miscellaneous	Over-Time Allowance (OTA) records	1 year from the end of the financial year to which the forms relate

Eighteen (18) Months — 1½ Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Delivery	Deposit Account	18 months
Delivery	Letter Postage Account	18 months
Money Order	Journals (lists) of MOs issued – HO & SO (MO.2)	18 months
Money Order	Register of MOs received for payment (MO.3)	18 months
Money Order	List of MOs Paid – HO & SO (MO.4)	18 months
Money Order	Compilation of MOs Paid (MO.23)	18 months
Money Order	Compilation of daily totals of MOs issued in SOs	18 months
Money Order	Postman's money-orders-paid books (MS.27)	18 months
Indian Postal Orders	List & Journals of IPOs sold	18 months
Indian Postal Orders	List of IPOs paid	18 months
Indian Postal Orders	Register of IPOs in stock	18 months
Sub Accounts	Sub Office daily accounts	18 months
Sub Accounts	Sub Office summaries	18 months
Sub Accounts	Branch Office summaries	18 months
Sub Accounts	Sub Office slips	18 months
Accounts	Remittance advice & acknowledgement	18 months
Accounts	Correspondence re losses, defalcations, etc.	18 months after final orders (1 year for POs & RMS offices)

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Registration & Parcel	Inward foreign parcel receipts / customs registers / assessment memos, etc.	1 – 1½ years (customs items: after final disposal of the item)
Savings Bank	Stock register of passbooks	18 months
Savings Bank	SB slip (SB.27)	18 months
Savings Bank	Duplicate copies of preliminary receipts (SB.26) held in the account office	18 months
Savings Certificates	Identity slips / counterfoils of POSCs	18 months after discharge of the certificates
Savings Certificates	Voucher List NC.31(a)	18 months (provided no objection is pending on non-receipt of returns in the PAO)
Savings Certificates	Daily summary of payment of Defence Deposit Certificates	18 months
Savings Certificates	Journals of certificates issued & discharged	18 months
Savings Certificates	Monthly summaries of certificates issued & discharged	18 months
Savings Certificates	SO & HO journals of certificates issued through Authorised Agents (NC.47 & NC.48)	18 months (do not destroy if commission remains unpaid)
Savings Certificates	Register of Sale of Gift Coupons	18 months after the Gift Coupons are discharged
Savings Certificates	List of Gift Coupons sold during the month	18 months
Miscellaneous	Records re issue of Identity Cards	1 – 1½ years after expiry of validity of the cards
Miscellaneous	Book of Postmarks (MS.18)	1 – 1½ years (destroyed by fire)
Miscellaneous	Other records of the Post Office (not specifically listed)	1 – 1½ years

Two (2) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Mail & Sorting	Mail Lists received & despatched	2 years
Franking Machine	FM records marked “-do-” (FM.3, FM.4, FM.5, FM.7, FM.8, FM.16, FM.14, FM.15)	2 years after expiry of validity date of licence
Franking Machine	Despatch slips for franked articles (FM.11)	2 years
Franking Machine	Franking Machine daily docket (FM.12)	2 years
Franking Machine	Register of repairs to Franking Machines – PMRO (FM.17)	2 years
Bag Account	Day bag book in UBOs / DBOs	2 years
Bag Account	Annexure ‘C’ (Bag balance reports)	2 years
Bag Account	Due bag lists	2 years
Bag Account	Register of closing balances in UBOs / DBOs	2 years
Bag Account	Register of bags exchanged with mails between Circles	2 years
Bag Account	Records of physical verification of bags	2 years
Money Order	Books of money-order receipts – HO & SO (MO.1)	2 years
Money Order	Files of cases containing paid MOs received from PAO	Files: 1 year; paid orders: 2 years
Sub Accounts	Branch Office daily accounts	2 years
Sub Accounts	Branch Office slips	2 years
Telephones	Daily lists of telephone revenue collections	2 years
Telephones	Counterfoils of receipts in Form Eng-9	2 years (departmental); guaranteed connections – till the connection is given up / guarantee terminated
Accounts	Statement of monthly progressive expenditure & discrepancy correspondence	2 years
Savings Bank	Register of undeliverable passbooks	2 years after all passbooks are transferred to SBCO
Savings Bank	Guard file – applications for local transfer of accounts	2 years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Bank	Index to preliminary receipts (MS.15)	2 years
Savings Bank	Duplicate copies of Advice of Transfer (SB.9 / SB.9a)	2 years (after Pairing Office certifies no item is outstanding as unpaired)
Savings Bank	Register of inward & outward advices of transfer	2 years
Savings Bank	SB voucher list (SB.22)	2 years
Savings Bank	Objection register (SB.61)	2 years after all objections are settled
Savings Bank	Register of SB passbooks received for entry of interest	2 years
Savings Bank	Duplicate copies of credit / debit SB transfer journals	2 years (after Pairing certificate)
Savings Bank	Register of discontinued CTD accounts revived	2 years after revival of last entry
Savings Bank	Register of collection cheques	2 years
Savings Bank	Stock register of SB cheque books	2 years
Savings Bank	Register of returned cheques	2 years
Savings Bank	Register of sanctions to BOs / ED SOs for withdrawals exceeding BPM / ED-SPM powers	2 years
Savings Bank	Guard book – letters of authority from illiterate / blind depositors (operation through agents)	2 years after accounts closed / transferred
Savings Bank	Guard book – Court orders re guardianship of minors	2 years after accounts closed / transferred
Savings Bank	Guard book – sanctions for opening Provident Fund accounts	2 years after accounts closed / transferred
Savings Bank	Guard book – powers of attorney	2 years after accounts closed / transferred
Savings Bank	List of “Will Follow” interest accounts	2 years
Savings Bank	Guard book – applications for change in name of SB depositors	2 years after the accounts are closed
Savings Bank	Guard book – letters of authority of SB depositors on active service	2 years after the accounts are closed
Savings Bank	Guard book – Court attachment orders of SB deposits	2 years after the accounts are closed
Savings Bank	Guard book – applications for issue of SB cheque books	2 years after the accounts are closed

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Bank	Guard books – lists of collection cheques (outstation / local / received from outstation)	2 years following the financial year to which the guard book belongs
Savings Bank	Receipt book for passbooks (SB.28)	2 years
Savings Bank	List of documents	2 years
Savings Bank	Long Books	2 years
Miscellaneous	Enumeration Returns (MS.6)	2 years
Miscellaneous	Confidential records / character sheets of officials who have died	2 years after death
Branch Post Office	Book of BO receipts (MS.87(a))	2 years
Branch Post Office	Registered lists / Parcel lists / Mail lists received & despatched	2 years
Branch Post Office	Branch Office slips	2 years
Branch Post Office	Village Postman's book of receipts (MS.87)	2 years
Branch Post Office	Book of Postmarks	2 years (destroyed by fire)

Three (3) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Franking Machine	Register by counter PA operating Multi-Value FM (FM.1)	3 years from date of last entry
Franking Machine	FM Register re postings – by licensee (FM.10)	3 years from date of last entry
Sub Accounts	Head Office Summary	3 years
Sub Accounts	Sub Office Accounts	3 years
Sub Accounts	Branch Office Accounts	3 years
Accounts	Head Office Cash Book	3 years
Accounts	Contingent Bills (copies)	3 years
Accounts	Schedule of receipts & payments (copies)	3 years
Accounts	Memo of disbursement of pay & allowances (with receipts)	3 years, or 1 year after completion of audit, whichever is later (i.e. max 3–6 years)

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Counterfoils of pay orders	3 years from issue of the last pay order
Accounts	Objection statements & retrenchment memoranda	3 years
Accounts	Receipts for money paid (other than those filed with acquittance rolls)	3 years
Accounts	Correspondence re sanctions & revision of establishments	3 years (POs / RMS: destroy as soon as a new revision is sanctioned)
Accounts	Papers re advances of pay, TA, purchase of motor cars, etc.	3 years
Accounts	Last Pay Certificates	3 years
Accounts	Renewal of sanctions to temporary establishment	3 years
Accounts	Receipts & invoices (except those under dispute)	3 years
Accounts	Demands for Licence Fee, etc. on departmental buildings	3 years
Accounts	Contingent Sub-Vouchers	3 years
Accounts	Budget estimates / revised estimates of an office	3 years
Accounts	Travelling Allowance bills & related Acquittance Rolls	3 years
Accounts	Expenditure sanctions (not otherwise protected), incl. grants-in-aid	3 years, or 1 year after completion of audit, whichever is later
Accounts	Arrear claims (incl. sanction for investigation)	3 years, or 1 year after audit, whichever is later
Accounts	Records re contingent expenditure	3 years, or 1 year after audit, whichever is later
Accounts	Schedules to establishment pay bills (period for which PBR is maintained)	3 years, or 1 year after audit, whichever is later
Accounts	Acquittance Rolls of pay & allowances (other than TA)	3 years, or 1 year after audit, whichever is later
Money Order	Records re inward / outward foreign MOs in exchange offices	3 years
Savings Bank	Special error book in the SB Branch	3 years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Bank	Books of preliminary SB receipts	3 years from issue of the last receipt
Savings Bank	Monthly statistical registers	3 years
Savings Bank	Interest payment orders received from the DPA	3 years
Savings Bank	Register of rectification of SB interest	3 years
Savings Bank	Register of deceased depositor's claim cases (files & records)	3 years after accounts closed (6 years where withdrawal is on an indemnity bond)
Savings Bank	Register with photographs & particulars of depositors	3 years after accounts closed / transferred
Savings Bank	Guard book – applications for new SB passbooks in lieu of spoilt ones	3 years
Savings Certificates	Yearly list of Unclaimed POSCs	3 years
Savings Certificates	Preliminary receipts NC-4(a)	3 years
Savings Certificates	Preliminary receipts NC-11	3 years
Savings Certificates	Guard book – applications for Gift Coupons (NC.40)	3 years after the Gift Coupons are discharged
Savings Certificates	Special error book (Savings Certificates)	3 years
Savings Certificates	Monthly statistical registers (Savings Certificates)	3 years
Savings Certificates	Invoices of Certificates	3 years
Savings Certificates	Ledger for commission to Authorised Agents (NC.49)	3 years from date of payment of commission (do not destroy if unpaid)
Savings Certificates	Authorised Agents' bills for commission earned (NC.50)	3 years from date of payment (do not destroy if unpaid)
Savings Certificates	Schedule of commission paid to Authorised Agents	3 years
Savings Certificates	Partially used-up Authorised Agents' receipt books	3 years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Certificates	Monthly statement of stock position of Certificates (SO → HO)	3 years
Savings Certificates	Claims to certificates of deceased holders	3 years after payment (6 years where payment is on indemnity bond)
Stock	Invoices of articles received from the Stock Depot	3 years
Stock	Carbonic copies of invoices returned to the Stock Depot	3 years
Staff	Gradation List	3 years after new ones are issued
Staff	Correspondence re personal files, appointments, nominations, leave, pension & punishments	3 years after the month the official ceased to belong to the Department
Staff	Service Books (including leave account)	3 years after death / retirement or date of final sanction of pension, whichever is later
Staff	Personal files	3 years after death / retirement or date of final sanction of pension, whichever is later
Miscellaneous	Register of Post Box Holders (M.23)	3 years
Miscellaneous	DG's Circulars & general orders (except permanent-nature / Govt.-loan instructions)	3 years after the following April
Miscellaneous	Postmaster's Order Book	3 years
Miscellaneous	Monthly statistical registers (Est-88, 90, 91, 92, etc.)	3 years
Miscellaneous	Monthly statistical abstract	3 years
Miscellaneous	Correspondence register	3 years
Miscellaneous	Cases of irregularities / complaints with a pecuniary claim made & rejected	3 years after the month the cases are closed
Branch Post Office	Branch Office account (Pa.6)	3 years after they are used up
Branch Post Office	Branch Office Journal (Pa.5) with BO slips	3 years after they are used up

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Branch Post Office	Invoices of publications & articles received from the Stock Depot	3 years

Four (4) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Register of losses, recoverable advances & retrenchments	4 years

Five (5) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Register of refunds (ACG-27)	5 years
Accounts	Register of Budget grants	5 years
Accounts	Service Rolls	5 years after death / resignation / discharge / retirement, whichever is earlier
Accounts	Register of cheque / receipt books	5 years from date of last entry
Accounts	Register of name, designation & pay, etc. of Gazetted Officers drawing pay	5 years
Accounts	Life Certificate & Certificate of unemployment from pensioners paid by MO	5 years
Accounts	Money-order receipts & acknowledgements of pensioners	5 years
Accounts	Bill Register (Form TR.28-A)	5 years
Accounts	Muster rolls & Register of muster rolls	5 years
Savings Bank	Specimen Signature Books – SO	5 years after all accounts are closed / transferred
Savings Bank	Register of nomination of SB accounts	5 years after all accounts & the related guard book are closed / settled
Savings Bank	Guard book – nomination / cancellation / variation applications	5 years after all accounts & the guard book are closed / settled

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Bank	Guard book – applications for revival of silent accounts	5 years (Rule 81, POSB Manual Vol. I)
Savings Bank	Error book – deposit by auto-transfer SB → CTD / RD	5 years
Record Keeping (SB / Certificates)	All Long Books & Lists of Transactions (hard or soft copy)	5 years
Record Keeping (SB / Certificates)	All ledger cards / account details (hard or soft copy), AOFs with CDD / KYC documents & SS Books	5 years after closure of the account
Record Keeping (SB / Certificates)	All account-closure vouchers	5 years from date of closure of the accounts
Record Keeping (SB / Certificates)	All purchase application forms with KYC / CDD documents	5 years after discharge of certificates
Savings Certificates	Application for Nomination (NC.51) / cancellation / variation (NC.53)	5 years + prescribed maturity / extended maturity, from date of discharge
Savings Certificates	Register of Nominations (NC.52)	5 years + prescribed maturity / extended maturity, from date of discharge
Miscellaneous	Confidential records / character sheets of officials who have retired	5 years after retirement (kept with pension cases)
Miscellaneous	Attendance Register (S.37)	5 years
Branch Post Office	Enumeration Returns	5 years
Branch Post Office	Yearly village returns	5 years

Six (6) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Grain compensation & overtime allowance, etc., bills	6 years
Accounts	Bills for reimbursement of medical charges	6 years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Bill of charges for conveyance of mails & payees' receipts (other than those filed with pay bills)	6 years
Savings Bank	Ledger cards of closed / transferred accounts & used-up ledger cards	6 years (provided ledger-agreement work is completed)
Savings Bank	SO SB Ledgers	6 years after all accounts are closed / transferred / recopied
Savings Bank	SO CTD journals of 5-year accounts	6 years from date of last entry
Savings Bank	SO journals of RD accounts (5 years)	6 years from date of last entry
Savings Bank	SO journals of FD accounts (5 years)	6 years from date of last entry
Savings Bank	SO journals of TD accounts (3 & 5 years)	6 years from last entry (1 & 2-year TD: 3 years from last entry)
Savings Bank	Index to Ledger Cards	6 years after all accounts are closed / transferred
Savings Bank	Guard books – applications for duplicate passbooks	6 years
Savings Certificates	Application for purchase / transfer (NC.69 / NC.71)	6 years after encashment on maturity / date of discharge
Savings Certificates	Applications in lieu of which duplicate certificates were issued	6 years + period of maturity / extended maturity, from discharge
Miscellaneous	Confidential records / character sheets of officials dismissed, removed or compulsorily retired (disciplinary measure)	6 years (kept with disciplinary proceedings)

Seven (7) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Staff	Records of appellate proceedings	7 years from date of disposal of the appeal

Ten (10) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Bag Account	Day bag books in CBOs	10 years
Bag Account	Stock Register (bags)	10 years
Bag Account	Repairable bags register	10 years
Bag Account	Unserviceable bags register	10 years
Treasury / Cash	Treasurer's Cash Book	10 years
Treasury / Cash	Treasury Passbook	10 years
Treasury / Cash	Cash Book (TR.4)	10 years
Treasury / Cash	Cash Book maintained by Drawing & Disbursing Officers	10 years
Sub Accounts	Treasurer's Cash Book	10 years
Accounts	Register of Security Deposits or Bonds	10 years
Accounts	Loan Register	10 years
Accounts	File Index Register	10 years
Savings Bank	Nominal roll kept in the SB / SC branch	10 years
Savings Certificates	Stock register of certificates	10 years after a new register is opened & the Postmaster initials the carried-forward entries
Savings Certificates	Nominal Roll kept in the SB & Savings Certificates branches	10 years
Miscellaneous	Records of disciplinary proceedings	10 years from date of disposal of the disciplinary case
Miscellaneous	Stock book	10 years after the year in which it is replaced by a fresh stock book

Twelve (12) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Bank	SO CTD journals of 10-year accounts	12 years from date of last entry

Eighteen (18) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Bank	SO CTD journals of 15-year accounts	18 years from date of last entry
Savings Certificates	Bonds of Indemnity for duplicate certificates – 7-year NSCs	18 years from date of issue

Twenty-One (21) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Certificates	Bonds of Indemnity for duplicate certificates – 10-year NPCs	21 years from date of issue

Twenty-Three (23) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Certificates	Bonds of Indemnity for duplicate certificates – 5-year NSCs, 12-year NSCs & 12-year NPSCs	23 years from date of issue

Twenty-Five (25) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Register of Files / Vouchers / Registers transferred to the Departmental recording wing (old records room)	25 years
Miscellaneous	Confidential records / character sheets of officials retired on invalid pension	25 years, or 3 years after death, whichever is earlier (kept with pension cases)

Thirty (30) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Savings Certificates	Unclaimed savings certificates in the custody of the Postal Accounts Office	30 years from date of maturity

Thirty-Five (35) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Letter of authority for payment to another person or agent	35 years
Accounts	Annual Establishment Return (Book of Establishment)	35 years
Accounts	Pay Bill Register	35 years
Accounts	Office copies of establishment pay bills & schedules (where PBR is not maintained)	35 years

Forty-Five (45) Years

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Acquittance Rolls of Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)	45 years (for verification of service)

Permanent

Branch / Section	Description of Record	Period of Preservation
Accounts	Runner's appointment certificates	Permanent
Accounts	Register for maintaining particulars of accounts records destroyed	Permanent
Accounts	Register of Destruction of Records (ACG-91)	Permanent
Accounts	Register of Files / Vouchers / Registers transferred to the National Archives	Permanent
Savings Bank	List of silent accounts received from SBCO by the Sub Offices	Permanent
Savings Bank	Ledger cards & ledger folios of silent accounts (extracted)	Permanent
Miscellaneous	Nominal Roll	Permanent
Branch Post Office	Circulars of the Head of the Circle containing convictions of departmental officials	Permanent

Note: The indemnity-bond ladder for duplicate certificates (18 / 21 / 23 years) all works out to 'six years beyond maturity or extended maturity' of the certificate concerned.

Part C — SB Control Organisation & Foreign Post

Quick-reference schedules for two special areas

C.1 Savings Bank Control Organisation (SBCO) & Pairing — key records

Authority: Rules 25, 42, 52, 62, 71 & 81 of the Postal Manual of SB Control, Pairing & Internal Check Organisation. The periods apply *mutatis mutandis* to CTD, FD, RD, TD and CDS records. Time-barred records are destroyed only after the prior approval of the Divisional Superintendent / Gazetted Postmaster, and their particulars are noted in the ACG-91 register.

Record	Period of Preservation
List of transactions	2 years after agreement of binder balances for that period
Consolidated journals of SB deposits & withdrawals	2 years after agreement of all binder balances
Combined local credit & debit transfer journals	18 months after agreement of all binder balances
Registers SB.62, SB.62(a) & SB.63	3 years after agreement of all binder balances
Register SB.61 (objections)	2 years after all objections are settled
Interest statement & summary thereof	3 years after agreement of binder balances
Statistical register	5 years after agreement of binder balances & reconciliation in the PAO
SB vouchers (incl. SB-3 applications with warrants of closed accounts)	6 years
Register of vouchers checked	6 years
Undeliverable passbooks	6 years from the year of their receipt
Spoilt passbooks / Unused cheque foils	Up to next inspection, then destroyed by the AO, ICO(SB)
Certified lists of accounts & balances	Permanent
Register of corrections to opening balances	Permanent
List of silent accounts	Permanent
Register of records destroyed (ACG-91)	Permanent

C.2 Internal Check Organisation (SB) – selected records

Record	Period of Preservation
SB / PPF annual interest statement	5 years after agreement of binder balances
Annual lists of balances (CTD / RD / TD / FD / CDS)	5 years after agreement of binder balances
Register of inspections	3 years
Ruling files / register of rulings & precedents	Permanent
Ledgers / lists of silent accounts	Permanent
Register of records destroyed	Permanent

C.3 Foreign Post – the general rule

Authority: Rule 11 of the Foreign Post Manual (read with Article 107 of the UPU documents). The **general period for foreign-post records is 18 months**; customs-assessment records run 18 months after the item is finally disposed of; and a few records carry longer periods, as below.

Record	Period of Preservation
General records of articles received / despatched by Foreign Post	18 months
Customs-assessment records	18 months after the item assessed to duty / under detention is finally disposed of
ACFM's order book	3 years
Records of inward foreign MOs in exchange offices	3 years
UK General & Parcel Account (Rule 400, Foreign Post Manual)	3 years
Stock Book of a Foreign Post Office	10 years after replacement
Article under dispute / enquiry in progress	Kept until settled, even beyond the prescribed period
UPU documents of the international service (Article 107)	Minimum 18 months from the day following the date to which they refer

Settlement of a disputed foreign-post case

If the enquiring administration, after being informed of the conclusions of the enquiry, allows **six months** to lapse without raising any objection, the case is treated as settled (Rule 11(1), Foreign Post Manual).

Sources & Authorities

The primary rules, manuals and circulars behind this booklet

This booklet has been compiled and cross-checked against the following primary sources. Where a specific provision has since been amended by a later order, **the latest order in force prevails**.

- Department of Posts — **Compendium on Preservation and Disposal of Records** (Rafi Ahmed Kidwai National Postal Academy, Ghaziabad); consolidated reference hosted on the DoP / CEPT portal — last updated 01 October 2024.
- **Postal Manual Volume VI, Part I** — Rule 25 (framework, method of destruction, records needing special permission) and the notes thereunder.
- **P&T Financial Hand Book (FHB) Volume I** — Appendix 5 (Annexure 'A', Parts I / II / III), Rule 69 (Form ACG-91) and Rule 94 (audit objections).
- **Post Office Savings Bank (POSB) Manual, Volumes I & II** — Savings Bank and Savings Certificate records (incl. Rule 81, Vol. I; Appendix III / VII).
- **Postal Manual of SB Control, Pairing & Internal Check Organisation** — SBCO / Pairing / ICO records.
- **Book of Rules for Branch Offices** (Rule 21) — Branch Post Office records.
- **Foreign Post Manual** (Rule 11, Rule 400) and Article 107 of the UPU documents — foreign-post records.
- **Manual of Office Procedure (P&T Circle Offices)** — Chapter VII (recording & record room).
- **Master Circular No. 1 on AML/CFT** — SB Order 14/2012, amended by SB Order 08/2013 — CBS-era record-keeping for SB / Certificates.
- **Postal Manual Volume III (Rule 154)** — records of appellate proceedings; **Postal Manual Volume VII (Rule 17)** — record / sub-record offices.

A note on currency & accuracy

The core retention periods for postal records are long-standing and stable. The most significant modern change is the *CBS / Finacle environment*, under which soft-copy long books, lists of transactions and ledger details are retained for the same periods as their physical equivalents, and Account Opening Forms with CDD/KYC documents are kept for 5 years after closure (SB Order 14/2012, as amended). Aspirants should always confirm the current position from the Department's latest circulars before relying on any figure for operational or audit use.

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